Guardian Angel

By Laurie Allen

LIGHTS UP on SETH, walking, texting, and not paying attention to where he is going. As he is about to step off the curb, GUARDIAN ANGEL comes up behind him and grabs the back of his shirt to stop him.

SETH: **(Pg 17-23)** *(Looks up to see a car speed by.)* Whoa! What the heck?! Did you see that?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Of course, I did.

SETH: But you … you just saved my life! That car almost ran me over!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Yep. Walking, texting, not paying attention … as usual. You almost walked right in front of that car.

SETH: *(Looks at his phone.)* Yeah … Well, thank you! Really, if it weren't for you right now, I'd be a goner. You were like my … my guardian angel!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I am.

SETH: You are what?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Your Guardian Angel.

SETH: And I seriously thank you from the bottom of my heart. . . What is your name?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Guardian Angel.

SETH: No, seriously.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Seriously.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 2: *(In a Newscasters voice) Guardian Angels: Fad, Fiction or Faithful Helpers?*
ACTOR 1: *Angels are everywhere: There are angel pins, angel plaques, angel apparel, entire stores and websites devoted to angels!*
ACTOR 2: *There are even folks out there who claim to be able to channel your guardian angel – for a fee, of course.*
ACTOR 1: *So imagine Seth's surprise when his Guardian Angel simply appeared one day, and was definitely NOT a cute, little, pudgy cherub!*
TOGETHER: *Guardian Angel by Laurie Allen*

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GUARDIAN ANGEL: Remember that time you tripped on the gravel and ripped your knee to shreds?

SETH: Uh, yeah ... ?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: And you had to go to the ER and have several rocks dug out of your flesh. I think you got a half-dozen stitches.

SETH: How do you know about that?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: *(Sticks his foot out as if tripping him.)* I was there. Unbeknownst to you, a rattlesnake was just down that path and would have bitten you. *(Smiles.)* That snake is my enemy. You know. Good versus Evil. Tell me you know which one I am.

SETH: Who are you?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I told you. Your Guardian Angel.

SETH: Right. Right.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Lucky for you, you got a smart one. And did I mention athletically inclined, witty, and, might we add- *(Slicks his hair back.)* good looking?

SETH: You're nuts! You weren't there when I was on that trail in Arizona. There's no way.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: *(Sticks out one foot.)* Oh, I was there. Believe me, I was there.

SETH: And you're saying that you tripped me and made me fall?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Only to save your life.

SETH: I don't believe you.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: And remember that time in high school when you tried to ask Jennifer to the dance, but the words just wouldn't come out of your mouth? *(Puts his hand over SETH'S mouth.)* I was doing this to you.

SETH: I do remember that. Somehow, I just couldn't get the words out.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: You should thank me.

SETH: Thank you? Thank you?!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: She would've said no. Actually, it wouldn't have been that nice. It

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would've been more like, "Only in your dreams, Seth!" So, I saved you from yourself.

SETH: That's not true! Jennifer would've said yes!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Sorry, buddy. But, no.

SETH: You don't know that! You're just some weird psycho person who's following me around for some unknown reason!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Oh! Oh! Oh! Remember that time in junior high when you got stuck in the boy's restroom?

SETH: How do you know about that?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Because I was the one holding the door shut, again saving you from a near disaster.

SETH: What disaster?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: The Wilson twins wanted to teach you a lesson. They were looking for you.

SETH: For that prank I pulled on them in the lunchroom?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: That's right. Dumb, dumb, dumb ... Replacing the white creamy middle of a chocolate sandwich cookie with toothpaste? Dumb, dumb, dumb ...

SETH: I was in junior high! junior high kids do dumb stuff!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: That's no exaggeration. Well, anyway, the Wilson boys were on their way to teach you a lesson, but I, being the observant and compassionate guardian angel that I am, spared you from getting a single scratch.

SETH: I'm not a coward!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: They would have eaten you for lunch.

SETH: No. I would've taken them down! Without a scratch on me.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: *(Laughs.)* Like Jennifer would have said, in your dreams.

SETH: Stop it! You weren't there!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: "Someone let me out! Please!" Good thing the Wilson twins didn't

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hear you screaming. "Someone help me! Help me! I can't breathe! I can't breathe in here!"

SETH: *(Angry.)* Who are you?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: And remember that time you tried to launch a homemade bottle rocket? Again, dumb idea. Dumb, dumb, dumb.

SETH: How do you know about that?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Thanks to my bravery, that bottle rocket fizzled out on the ground instead of catching your parents' house on fire!

SETH: That was you?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Plus, you would've caught your hair on fire.

SETH: But that rocket was for a science project. It was going to be so cool.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Cool to suffer third degree bums over half your body?

SETH: But... you?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Yep! Go me! I saved the day. As usual. Do you want to thank me now?

SETH: *(Reaches out to touch him.)* Whoa! I can see you, but I can't feel you!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I'm invisible too. Well, to everyone but you right now.

SETH: How is this possible?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I thought a little gratitude was in order. You've put me through a lot, you know? Playing on the train tracks, the bull riding adventure, hang gliding over the cliffs with your own contraption, shark hunting ... Oh, and remember that time you had the great idea to jump into a swimming pool... with no water!

SETH: I was going to land on a mattress! Well, that was the plan.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Two words, major head injury.

SETH: That's three words.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Whatever.

SETH: Oh, great! I have a guardian angel with an attitude.

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GUARDIAN ANGEL: Learned it from you. So, how about a little gratitude here? You've made my job very difficult, you know?

SETH: How about this? I free you. You are free to leave me and look after someone else.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Really? You really want to live your life without a guardian angel?

SETH: I'll be fine.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I wouldn't count on it. Not with all your great ideas!

SETH: I'm sure. Your services are no longer needed. So, poof and be gone! (Pause.) Go, I said! *(GUARDIAN ANGEL pushes him.)* Why did you do that?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: One last time for old time's sake. You know, pushing you out of the way of dangerous situations.

SETH: Well, your services are no longer needed!

GUARDIAN ANGEL: I wouldn't be so sure about that, if I was you. Because this afternoon ... well, never mind. *(Turns to go.)*

SETH: What? What?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Maybe you can join my team after today. Become a guardian angel. I wonder who you'll get to follow around all day? (Points.) Maybe him.

SETH: Him? That old man with the tattoo?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: *(Points.)* Or her.

SETH: The mother of three?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: And no sleeping on the job. You must be alert at all times.

SETH: Why would I become a guardian angel this afternoon?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Well, since you've let me go ... and after the upcoming incident this afternoon ... *(Pats him.)* Maybe you'll be on my team! Team 472013. That's my team. And might I add, we've had one of the least mistakes known to human kind.

SETH: Mistakes?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Late interferences. Not paying attention and saving people in time.

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I take my job very seriously! Well, most of the time. I did fail you once. Remember that choking incident when you were eating the breakfast burrito? I clearly was not paying attention. Thank goodness your friend Joe stepped in. A little Heimlich maneuver and you were good to go. Sorry about that.

SETH: What were you doing?

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Talking to my friend, Cosima. She has the most beautiful long hair, big beautiful eyes, a smile to die for ... Well, not you. I keep you from that. But, wow, does she make my heart flip-flop. So, my heart was flipflopping while you were choking on your burrito. Again, sorry about that.

SETH: Well, like I said. Your services are no longer needed. I can take care of myself, thank you very much.

GUARDIAN ANGEL: Well, okay, then. I'm out of here. *(EXITS.)*

SETH: *(Calls OFF)* Great. See ya. *(Thinks.)* But ... I wonder what's going to happen to me this afternoon. Something's supposed to happen. Well, that's just dumb. I'm being dumb. Nothing is going to happen. *(Thinks. Calls OFF)* Wait! Wait! Come back! I've changed my mind about firing you. Come back! *(Thinks.)* I know! I'm going to go home, crawl into bed, put the sheets over my head, and stay there all day! *(Rushes OFF)*

GUARDIAN ANGEL: *(ENTERS, having not heard SETH.)* What does he think he's doing? He can't fire me! And when that ceiling fan breaks loose from the ceiling, I'll be there to spare his life. Again. As always. Over and over again. Go me. *(Sighs.)* I need a raise. *(Starts to run OFF after SETH.)* Wait for me! You can't get through your life without me!

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